

# J. Gabriel Connolly

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## EDUCATION

### University of Central Florida

*B.S. in Computer Science, Dean's List, Bright Futures Florida Academic Scholarship Recipient*

Orlando, FL

*Expected May 2027*

## EXPERIENCE

### Wells Fargo

Charlotte, NC

*Sophomore SWE Intern — Wealth & Investment Management Technology*

*June 2025 – July 2025*

- Authored a **15 page migration playbook** comparing Pivotal Cloud Foundry vs. Red Hat OpenShift, documenting tradeoffs in scalability, deployment models, and developer workflows used by **100+ engineers**.
- Validated **20+ financial API endpoints** with Postman, debugging payloads and authentication flows, and built reproducible test cases for distributed workflows.
- Analyzed production logs in **Splunk** to trace errors across microservices, strengthening ability to diagnose issues in large-scale event-driven systems.
- Collaborated in agile sprints, attending stand-ups, **backlog grooming**, and sprint reviews while learning **enterprise CI/CD** and regulated release governance.

### The Region

Jacksonville, FL

*Software Developer Apprentice*

*May 2021 – July 2022*

- Aided development of Java plugins using Spigot API and Bungee API for a video game server peaking at **750 concurrent players**.
- Architected and implemented performance optimizations such as asynchronous task scheduling, and chunk-loading tweaks, that **cut average tick times by 30%** and **reduced server downtime by 40%**.
- Led lifecycle from **feature planning** to **deployment and live support**, improving user experience and server stability.

## PROJECTS

### MemorAI | ONNX, ArcFace, FAISS, React, Firebase, Azure Blob, Submitted to ShellHacks 2025

Sept 2025

- Built a **FastAPI microservice** with **InsightFace** and **FAISS** for real-time face recognition, cutting average latency from **5s to <1s** through detection size tuning and tracking heuristics.
- Developed an **AR interface** in Next.js/TypeScript that overlays dynamic “memory cards” on recognized faces, displaying names, relationships, and activities with **95% alignment accuracy**.
- Integrated **FAISS similarity search** with an **Azure/Firebase backend**, scaling recognition from **~20 to 100+ enrolled people** and supporting retrieval of **1,000+ photos + captions** without latency loss.

### Paracosm | Unity, OpenAI Whisper, React, C#, Git, MetaQuest, Submitted to Bitcamp 2025

Apr 2025

- **Engineered a Perlin-noise terrain algorithm** to produce **10+ distinct biomes** in real time at **60 FPS** within a Unity WebGL embed.
- Integrated OpenAI Whisper for voice commands, achieving **90% recognition accuracy** across **150+ commands**.
- Implemented **VR integration with Meta Quest**, enabling **5+ interactive hand-tracking gestures** for immersive navigation in procedurally generated worlds.

### HurricaneGIS | Node.js, MongoDB, React, Mongoose, Submitted to Knight Hacks VII

Oct 2024

- Developed a full stack GIS web tool that processed **200+ hazard reports in real time**, improving from a baseline capacity by 30%, by integrating MongoDB, Mongoose, and Google Maps API.
- Implemented user authentication and hazard submission with **Mongoose**, reducing duplicate hazard reports by **30%** through verification checks and improving data accuracy in testing.

## LEADERSHIP & AWARDS

### Knight Hacks

Orlando, FL

*Director of Outreach*

*Dec 2024 – Present*

- Designed and implemented outreach campaigns across UCF's CS and CE departments, contributing to a **102% increase in new member signups**.
- Converted outreach into **1,000+ participants** and establishing Knight Hacks as a top Southeast collegiate hackathon.

### Theta Chi Fraternity

Orlando, FL

*Secretary, Risk Manager, Scholarship Chair*

*Nov 2023 – Present*

- Awarded with the **Victor Simon Scholarship**, **Janet Roberts Blue Scholarship**, and **Resolute Man Award** for academic excellence, leadership, and professional promise as an engineering major in Theta Chi.

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

**Programming Languages:** Java, Python, C, C#, JavaScript/TypeScript, HTML, CSS

**Libraries/Frameworks:** FastAPI, React, Next.js, Spring Boot, Unity, OpenCV, InsightFace, FAISS, Firebase, numpy

**Tools/Platforms:** Git, Linux, Azure, CI/CD, Postman, Agile/Scrum